

GOLDEN INITIATIVE

U.S.-PHILIPPINES INSTANT REMITTANCE SERVICE

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IMPORTANT NOTICE

This document contains synthetic information created for demonstration purposes only. It does not represent a real customer, transaction, partner, approval, regulatory filing, or production control. It must not be used as evidence for an actual financial-crime decision.

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Golden Initiative proposes a bounded digital remittance service that allows customers in the United States to send funds to recipients in the Philippines through mobile and web channels.

The initial launch would use a local payment partner to support recipient-wallet funding. The service would include transaction limits, customer screening, sanctions screening, fraud monitoring, transaction monitoring, operational ownership, and documented escalation procedures.

The initiative is intended to proceed through a controlled assessment process before any production launch decision is made.

2. BUSINESS OBJECTIVE

The objective is to provide a faster and lower-friction remittance experience while maintaining appropriate financial-crime, fraud, operational, and third-party risk controls.

The initial service should be deliberately bounded to:

- U.S.-based senders
- Philippines-based recipients
- Mobile and web channels
- A verified local payment partner
- An initial transaction limit of USD 1,000 per transaction
- Documented monitoring and escalation ownership
- A staged rollout with measurable launch conditions

3. USERS AND STAKEHOLDERS

Primary users:

- Existing U.S. customers
- Philippines-based recipients
- Customer operations teams
- Financial-crime risk and compliance analysts
- Fraud and transaction-monitoring teams
- Product and engineering teams
- The local payment partner
- Internal approval or governance committee

Accountable owner:

Maya Chen, Product Owner

The accountable owner is responsible for coordinating the initiative, confirming that required controls have owners, and ensuring unresolved issues are presented to the appropriate decision-makers.

4. KEY RISK AREAS

4.1 Cross-border payment risk

The service moves funds between the United States and the Philippines. Cross-border activity requires appropriate customer, beneficiary, transaction, and jurisdictional information to support screening and monitoring.

4.2 Sanctions and watchlist risk

Senders, recipients, payment partners, and relevant transaction information should be screened against applicable sanctions and watchlists before funds are released.

Potential control expectations:

- Screening before transaction completion
- Rescreening when relevant information changes
- Documented handling of potential matches
- Escalation of unresolved matches
- Retention of screening outcomes

4.3 Fraud and account-takeover risk

Instant payments may increase the speed at which fraudulent transactions are completed. The service should identify unusual login, device, transaction, beneficiary, and velocity patterns.

Potential control expectations:

- Multi-factor authentication or equivalent account protection
- New-beneficiary cooling-off or risk checks
- Transaction velocity limits
- Device and behavioral monitoring
- Manual review for suspicious activity
- Customer notification and recovery procedures

4.4 Transaction-monitoring risk

The service may be used to move funds in patterns that are inconsistent with a customer's expected activity.

Potential monitoring indicators include:

- Repeated transfers near transaction limits
- Rapid movement through newly added recipients
- Multiple senders using the same recipient or funding source
- Unusual geographic or device changes
- Sudden increases in transaction volume
- Structuring activity designed to avoid review thresholds

Monitoring rules, alert ownership, investigation procedures, and escalation timelines must be documented before launch.

4.5 Third-party partner risk

The local payment partner will be involved in recipient-wallet funding and may provide services that affect transaction processing, screening, reconciliation, and incident handling.

Required partner diligence should include:

- Ownership and corporate information
- Licensing or authorization status
- Financial-crime compliance framework
- Sanctions and screening capabilities
- Security and privacy controls
- Incident-notification commitments
- Service-level expectations
- Audit and information-access rights
- Business continuity arrangements
- Exit and transition planning

4.6 Data privacy and information-security risk

The service will process customer, recipient, transaction, device, and screening information. Access should be limited to authorized personnel and retained according to approved requirements.

Potential control expectations:

- Data minimization
- Role-based access
- Encryption in transit and at rest
- Audit logging
- Secure secrets management
- Retention and deletion rules
- Incident response procedures
- Controlled access for the payment partner

5. PROPOSED CONTROL ENVIRONMENT

The following controls are proposed for the initial bounded launch:

1. Customer identity and account verification before sending funds.
2. Screening of sender, recipient, partner, and transaction information.
3. Transaction and daily velocity limits.
4. Fraud monitoring and suspicious-activity escalation.
5. Manual review for high-risk or anomalous transactions.
6. Payment-partner due diligence and documented ownership.
7. Reconciliation between Fulcrum, the payment system, and the partner.
8. Role-based access to customer and transaction information.
9. Immutable audit records for important workflow actions.
10. Documented incident response and partner escalation procedures.
11. Periodic review of monitoring rules and transaction limits.
12. Evidence retention for assessment and launch decisions.

Controls reduce risk but do not eliminate it. Any residual risk should be clearly documented and accepted only by an authorized decision-maker.

6. OPERATING MODEL

The proposed operating sequence is:

1. A customer initiates a remittance.
2. The sender and recipient information is validated.
3. Applicable screening checks are performed.
4. Fraud and transaction-monitoring checks are evaluated.
5. Transactions requiring review are held for investigation.
6. Approved transactions are submitted to the payment partner.
7. Fulcrum and the partner reconcile the transaction outcome.
8. Exceptions are assigned to an accountable owner.
9. Material incidents are escalated according to the approved procedure.
10. Metrics and control performance are reviewed after launch.

7. INITIAL LAUNCH CONDITIONS

The initiative should not proceed to production launch until the following conditions are addressed:

- The payment partner has completed due diligence.
- Screening responsibilities are clearly assigned.
- Transaction and velocity limits are approved.
- Fraud and monitoring rules have named owners.
- Manual-review procedures are documented.
- Customer and recipient data handling is approved.
- Reconciliation and exception handling are tested.
- Incident escalation paths are confirmed.
- Audit and evidence-retention requirements are documented.
- A rollback or service-suspension process is available.
- Outstanding high-risk findings have an authorized disposition.

8. EVIDENCE TO COLLECT

The assessment should collect or reference:

- Partner due-diligence results

- Service and process diagrams
- Screening configuration
- Fraud and monitoring rule specifications
- Transaction-limit rationale
- Access-control design
- Security and privacy review
- Incident-response procedure
- Reconciliation test results
- User-acceptance testing results
- Open risk and issue register
- Named control owners
- Approval or committee decision record

9. OPEN QUESTIONS

The following questions require confirmation before launch:

- Which legal entities will provide the service?
- Which entity is responsible for customer and recipient screening?
- What transaction and daily limits are appropriate for the initial rollout?
- Which payment partner capabilities have been independently verified?
- What events trigger manual review?
- How long should review and escalation take?
- What evidence must be retained for each transaction?
- How will failed, delayed, reversed, or disputed transactions be handled?
- Which countries or customer segments are excluded from the initial release?
- Who has authority to pause the service?
- What metrics determine whether the pilot can expand?

10. PROPOSED SUCCESS METRICS

The initial rollout should monitor:

- Transaction completion rate
- Failed and reversed transaction rate
- Screening-alert rate
- Fraud-alert rate
- Manual-review volume
- Average review time
- Unresolved exception count
- Partner reconciliation breaks
- Customer complaints
- Unauthorized-access incidents
- Control testing completion
- Number and severity of open risk findings

Metrics should be reviewed by the accountable product owner, operations, financial-crime risk, and other designated governance stakeholders.

11. ASSESSMENT CONCLUSION

The Golden Initiative may be suitable for a controlled, staged assessment and pilot if the proposed controls, partner diligence, monitoring responsibilities, evidence requirements, and launch conditions are completed and reviewed by authorized decision-makers.

This document does not approve the initiative, certify regulatory compliance, or replace legal, compliance, security, privacy, or operational review.

Prepared for: FULCRUM synthetic guided demo

Accountable owner: Maya Chen

Related initiative: U.S.–Philippines Instant Remittance